

Cerdocyon thous

Crab-eating fox



Location N. and E. South America

Length 22½–30 in (57–77.5 cm)

Tail 9–16 in (22–41 cm)

Weight 10–19 lb (4.5–8.5 kg)

Social unit Group/Pair

Status Least concern



In addition to crabs—both coastal and freshwater—this medium-sized fox eats much else, including fish, reptiles, birds, mammals, grubs, and fruit. Widespread in many habitats, it shows much variation across its range, although the body is generally gray-brown, with reddish brown face, ears, and front legs, a white underside, and black on the tips of the ears and tail, and the backs of the legs. Active at night, it lives in loose social groups of an adult pair and their offspring.

*Nyctereutes procyonoides*

Raccoon dog



Location Europe, C., N., and E. Asia

Length 19½–28 in (49–71 cm)

Tail 6–9 in (15–23 cm)

Weight 6½–28 lb (2.9–12.5 kg)

Social unit Group/Pair

Status Least concern

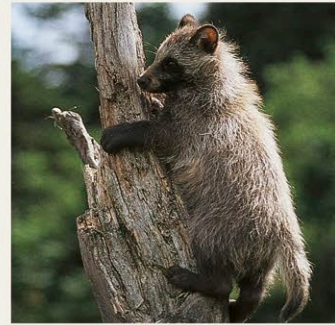


This canid resembles a combination of raccoon and dog, with its black face “mask” and variable black fur on the shoulders and upperside of the tail. It is nocturnal and has a huge dietary range, from fruit to birds, mice, crabs, and fish. It also forages along river banks,



lakesides, and the seashore. It lives in pairs or loose family groups; litter size varies from 4–9, depending on the locality. The raccoon dog is abundant in Japan, extinct in parts of China, yet spreading rapidly in areas of Europe, where it has been introduced.

READY FOR WINTER



The raccoon dog is an unusual member of the dog family—even youngsters can climb well. During harsh winters they enter a form of hibernation known as winter lethargy, when their body temperature drops only a few degrees. Autumn feasting increases body weight by up to 50 percent.

COLORATION

This raccoonlike dog has long, yellow-tinged, brown-black body fur (especially in winter), black facial patches below the eyes, a white muzzle, short-furred legs, and a bushy tail.

Speothos venaticus

Bush dog



Location Central America to N. and C. South America

Length 22½–30 in (57–75 cm)

Tail 5–6 in (12.5–15 cm)

Weight 11–15 lb (5–7 kg)

Social unit Group

Status Near threatened



Long-bodied and short-legged, this day-active predator lives in family-based packs of up to 12. It is a powerful and persistent hunter of ground birds and rodents up to the size of Azara's agouti (see p.130). The pack, however, tackles larger prey, such as rheas and capybaras, swimming efficiently after victims. By night, the group members sleep in dens, in deserted burrows, hollow logs, or under rocks. Average litter size is 4, born after a gestation of 67 days. The male brings food to the female in the den prior to the birth and throughout nursing.

*Chrysocyon brachyurus*

Maned wolf



Location C. and E. South America

Length 3¼–4 ft (1–1.2 m)

Tail 15–20 in (38–50 cm)

Weight 45–66 lb (20.5–30 kg)

Social unit Individual

Status Near threatened



Similar to a red fox (see p.169), but with very long legs, this wolf has long, thick, reddish yellow fur, a black neck crest, central back stripe, and black muzzle. It prefers open, grassy, or low-scrub habitats where it can peer over vegetation for prey and danger. Female and male share a territory, and mate each year, usually in May or June, but otherwise rarely associate. Active at twilight and night, the maned wolf takes a varied diet, including rabbits, birds, and mice, as well as smaller creatures such as grubs and ants, and also appreciable amounts of plant material such as fruit



very long, black-haired legs

and berries. It is said to kill livestock, especially poultry, and so is hunted as a pest in some areas—yet it is kept as a pet in others. Disease is another major threat. The gestation period is 62–66 days, and the 1–7 pups (average 3) are born in an above-ground den in thick grass or bushes. The mother cares for them alone, suckling them for up to 15 weeks.

Canis adustus

Side-striped jackal



Location W., C., E., and southern Africa

Length 25½–32 in (65–81 cm)

Tail 12–16 in (30–41 cm)

Weight 14–31 lb (6.5–14 kg)

Social unit Pair

Status Least concern



often indistinct white and black side stripes

gray-yellow coat paler on underside

white tail tip

Sometimes sighted foraging at night near city centers, the side-striped jackal is also found in grass, along forest edges, and in mixed farmland. More omnivorous than other jackals, it takes rodents, birds, eggs, lizards, insects and other invertebrates, refuse, carrion, and plant material such as fruit and berries. The basic social group is a female–male pair with their young, which can number up to 6 (average 5 per litter). Offspring are born after a gestation period of about 60 days, in a secure den such as an old termite mound or aardvark burrow. Weaned by 10 weeks, they become independent at about 8 months.